

Coppypasta or How to Recycle Computer Science Articles: A Delicious Case Study

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Abstract

Every year, countless computer science articles are thrown out because their authors could not finish them before a conference deadline. These papers are sent to the *wasteland of ideas*, polluting it for everyone. To face this evergrowing crisis, we propose to recycle these papers to create new delicious articles that advance science in a meaningful way. Through a tasty case study, we demonstrate the feasibility of our approach by recycling a staggering proportion of an unfinished scientific article.

1 Introduction

In recent years, the world has observed a meteoric rise in the number of published scientific articles [1] as seen in Figure 1. While this rise is representative of a positive trend in science (after all, reviewers love reading papers), many unfinished papers are simply thrown away in the wastelands of ideas, creating unprecedented ecological waste. The great pacific garbage patch, for all we know, could very well be formed by up to 96% of unfinished papers. As an additional evidence, the number of unfinished papers in the first author’s hard drive is large enough to be concerning.

Faced with this urgent issue (and perhaps motivated by yet another failed deadline), we propose to envision a novel solution: the recycling of unfinished papers’ materials. Since the value of research can clearly be measured with metrics such as the number of produced papers or the citation count, it is self evident that recycling papers into new content provide tremendous value. This is where our methodology shines. By taking n garbage papers and mixing them together, the same way the american real estate market created the bonds that led to the blooming of the economy in 2008, we create high value papers by adding their potential citations together.

While the recycling task can seem daunting, we will clearly show the interest of our approach in the rest of this article through a mouth-watering case study. Or, as we might say informally, “*Let us cook!*”.



Figure 1: The only non-recycled figure of this article. Clearly, given its quality, a recycled figure would have been better.

2 Methods

“Our methods may seem strange and indirect. Even incomprehensible. But I assure you we know what we’re doing.” – This sentence from Philip K. Dick is a vibrant example of our method. By copy-and-pasting it in this paper, we effectively “recycle” it, saving it from the wasteland of ideas and limiting the growth of the already gigantic great pacific garbage patch. This copy-and-past paradigm is central to recycling. Unfortunately, certain paper materials cannot be recycled that easily: copy-and-pasting just won’t do. In these cases, a simple modification of the original material can often make it suitable for recycling. We denote this new technique “copy-and-past-and-sometimes-modify”, or “coppypasta”TM for short. We will demonstrate how to do that in the rest of this article.

It is a common opinion that garbage in equals garbage out. But our novel coppypastaTM technique takes garbage in and transforms it into great value thanks to precise and innovative AGI-ready technology (I need funding, please). The goal is to create value, value comes from the needs of the market, but you first need to determine the market you are targeting. What market is interested in garbage? The recycling market and the raccoon community. For obvious reasons, we will in this research only focus on the second market as it is currently blooming (source needed). The transformative idea is to scale the garbage collection, in a similar way Java does with its JVM, and input so much garbage that not even the latest Gemini Flash Pro Sonnet 6.93 could fit it in his context. Rendering the content undeniably impossible to denote from a perfectly forged triple A journal accepted piece of art. When recycling materials, one has to make sure enough materials are available to form a coherent recycled product. After all, in the words of chef Yotam Ottolenghi, *“When it comes to cooking pasta, the first essential is to make sure you have a big enough pot: it needs room to roll in the water while cooking.”*. Therefore, only large research efforts should be recycled: small efforts are not yet a waste (although they could



Figure 2: A programming cookbook that will surely be useful to the research community.

certainly become one in the future).

Now that our method is clear as (cooking) water, the rest of this paper will consist in a series of paper-related recycling examples and techniques, in order to highlight the strength of our method and provide a tutorial on paper recycling.

3 Code Artifacts

Reproducibility is a central concern in the modern computer science landscape, so articles often comes with some implementation code attached. That is not to say the code is reproducible however, so additionally to unfinished papers, even finished papers contain content that could be recycled¹. This represents a typical “spaghetti code” situation, and spaghetti should not be wasted. An excellent recycling opportunity is the creation of a *programming cookbook*: this can act as a serious resource for the community, as well as giving the secret sauce for your spaghetti, as illustrated in Figure 2.

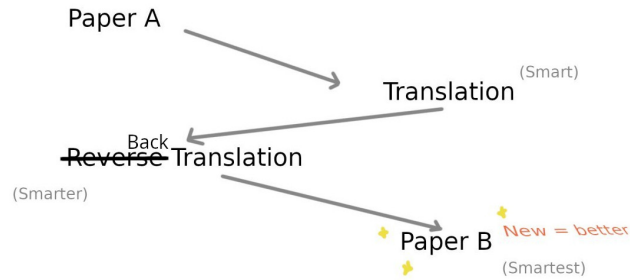


Figure 3: The “translation into backtranslation” technique.

4 Translation Into Backtranslation

Translation systems have been making remarkable progress in the last few years (reference needed). This has unlocked new applications, such as the “translation into backtranslation” trick that can be used effectively to recycle papers. Suppose you start with a terrible paper in English that was rejected from three international conferences in a row. To avoid throwing this marvelous piece of work and losing it forever, a solution is to first translate it into your (non-English) local language and publish into a less competitive national conference. At the same time, the article can be backtranslated from your language to English and resubmitted to all of the international conferences it was rejected from. This can be achieved multiple times for maximum recyclability. We present an evaluation in Table 1. Note that this evaluation is irrelevant to the translation into backtranslation trick, as it is a recycled table.

5 The “Papier-mâché” Technique

When the “translation into backtranslation” technique cannot save you anymore (e.g. some reviewer noticed that you submitted the first paper four times and is starting to complain), another possibility is to apply the “Papier-mâché” technique. This delicate cooking technique consists in putting all the words in a big enough pot and stirring with vigor and cutting-edge algorithms to obtain a juicy soup. As a succulent practical example:

Facts 16 per 5840 generating [2026-01-01,2026-12-31] exponential methodology. 31 different relations 200 random walks to TLogic TKGF system. Appendix clusters of 2 to 4 facts iteratively apply benchmarks. Our YAGO 4.5 TKG rules of length 1, 2, and 3 description examples. Methodology application 1182 generate evaluation future. Appendix A continuous transition distribution. TKGE dataset facts 2026-12-31 highlight 0.73costs. *Small total example of four generated descriptions Appendix B. Appro*

¹On the good side, if the code is hosted on GitHub, it actually costs Microsoft money.

System	Strict	Exact	Type	Partial	Strict	Exact	Type	Partial
few-shots w/ Mistral-7B	60.36	62.66	63.32	63.99	77.84	81.01	83.34	83.55
few-shots w/ Llama3.1-8B	79.79	82.90	83.57	84.70	80.29	83.67	84.88	85.84
EDC w/ Mistral-7B	63.61	65.84	68.88	68.39	76.58	79.40	82.63	82.31
EDC w/ Llama3.1-8B	72.84	76.09	81.07	80.04	71.76	75.15	80.24	79.25

Table 1: Our results are better than the baseline by an extremely large margin.

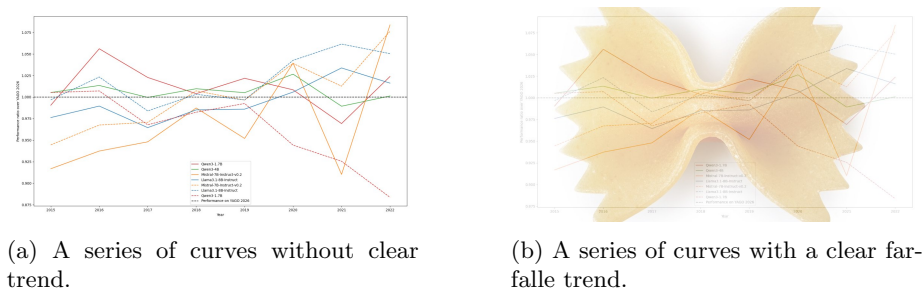


Figure 4: With a good eye for patterns, even useless results can be recycled.

6 Results

Recycling incomprehensible results is a skill that can be refined by exercise. We observe that good pattern matching abilities are useful in general. 4 Figures 4a and 4b clearly illustrates this: while the left curves seem to show no evident patterns in the raw results, the trained eye can easily cook these results and observe a farfalle shape which elegantly complements the spaghetti code presented earlier.

Another, more direct way of recycling results is to simply dump numbers directly in your paper. Large tables are never understood completely by 97% of scientists, and the other 3% of scientists are only statistical noise, so you can easily copy-paste large tables. The important thing is to make illusion, so indicating that your results are “better” than the filthy baselines is a good idea.

7 Conclusion

If, like us, you are fond of pasta, there is a high chance that our recycling examples already convinced you of the benefits of cospypasta™. The pasta presented in this article should be heated for 11 minutes. Don’t forget to add salt! For unconvinced readers, we will conclude by saying that is a well know scientific fact that pastas are always better reheated [2], so re-heating your paper materials always make them better.

References

- [1] M. Fire and C. Guestrin. “Over-optimization of academic publishing metrics: observing Goodhart’s Law in action”. In: *GigaScience* 8.6 (2019). ISSN: 2047-217X. DOI: 10.1093/gigascience/giz053.
- [2] M. T. Robertson et al. “The cumulative effects of chilling and reheating a carbohydrate-based pasta meal on the postprandial glycaemic response: a pilot study”. In: *European Journal of Clinical Nutrition* (2021), pp. 570–572. DOI: 10.1038/s41430-020-00736-x.